PROBLEM STATEMENT

Date	3-October- 2026
TeamID	6ab4e9dea238dc999eb61f08
ProjectName	**Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**
Maximum Marks	3 Marks

PROBLEM STATEMENT

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, particularly in the handling of standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require an additional configuration step, but this step is prone to oversight or delay. Such delays can affect the time taken to prepare laptops for users and can create unnecessary manual overhead for the IT procurement and hardware teams.

Problem Context

A standard laptop request is initiated through the ServiceNow Service Catalog. After the request is submitted, the required approval must be completed before the laptop configuration work can proceed. In a manual process, the creation and assignment of the configuration task may require additional intervention. This creates a gap between an approved request and the actual operational task required to configure the laptop.

User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Key Problems Identified

- Manual effort is required in handling standard laptop procurement activities.
- The configuration step can be overlooked or delayed after a request is submitted.
- Delays in configuration may increase the waiting time for users.
- Manual allocation of configuration work can result in inefficient resource utilisation.
- The procurement process needs better integration between the Service Catalog request, approval, and configuration task.

Need for an Automated Process

The project therefore requires an automated mechanism that can recognise the relevant Service Catalog process and create the required configuration task when the request reaches the approved condition. The automation should reduce repetitive manual work and provide a consistent transition from the approved request to the hardware configuration activity.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

PROJECT OBJECTIVE AND PROPOSED SOLUTION

The objective of the project is to implement an automated workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. The project aims to create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops, reduce manual intervention and potential errors, improve resource utilisation through appropriate task allocation, and enhance overall efficiency and productivity within IT procurement operations.

Proposed Solution

The project creates a Flow Designer flow named “Standard laptop task.” The flow uses a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action. The Requested Item record is provided to the action, and the generated task is configured with the short description “Laptop need to Configured.” The Assignment group is set to “Hardware” and the Approval value is set to “Approved.” After configuration, the flow is saved and activated.

Integration with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog

The completed flow is assigned to the Standard Laptop service catalog item through the Process Engine configuration. The Standard Laptop item is then used to place the order. The request proceeds through the approval process, and after approval the Flow Designer automation creates the Catalog Task associated with the Requested Item.

Expected Improvements

- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops.
- Ensure timely generation of the configuration task after approval.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilisation by automatically assigning work to the Hardware group.
- Enhance efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

Problem-to-Solution Flow

The intended process is: Standard Laptop Service Catalog order → request submission → approval → Flow Designer automation → Catalog Task creation → Assignment Group set to Hardware → laptop configuration. This automated sequence addresses the manual overhead and delay identified in the original procurement process.

Conclusion

The project addresses inefficiencies in standard laptop procurement by automating the transition from an approved Service Catalog request to a configuration task. By using ServiceNow Flow Designer, the solution is designed to reduce manual intervention, support timely laptop configuration, optimise task allocation, and improve the overall user and IT procurement experience.